

Few vegetarians lack dietary fiber if they are eating vegetables and whole grains but should be aware that iron can be bound by other plant compounds, and drinking tea or coffee with meals hinders absorption. An iron supplement may be needed.

Biotin, a B vitamin, is vital for the early development of a baby's genetic structure. The best sources are meat, fish, and poultry, but vegetarians can obtain biotin from eggs, peanuts, and almonds. Although the body can convert the omega-3 fatty acid called alpha linoleic acid (ALA) into the EPA and DHA your baby needs (see [The power of omega-3](#)), it makes sense for vegetarians to take a supplement providing these marine-based omega-3 fatty acids. Algae provide fish with the DHA and EPA, so look for vegetarian-friendly EPA/DHA supplements.

If you are vegetarian, also eat plenty of foods rich in ALA, including canola oil, flaxseed, pumpkin seeds, and walnuts, as regularly as you can.